Iteration I1: Authenticating Users

Building a user administration system is a common task in web applications. Rails provides a generator to help you get started. The code it generates is a good starting point, and takes care of important details like storing passwords securely. It builds upon sessions, mailers, and jobs, which we've seen in previous chapters.

We start by running the generator:

```
depot> bin/rails generate authentication
```

This creates three models: `Session`, `User`, and `Current`. It creates controllers for sessions and passwords and a controller concern for authentication. Finally, it creates views for passwords and their associated mailer. The one task it leaves to you is the task of defining the user. We could create this from scratch, but we'll use the scaffold generator to get us started and tell it to *not* modify what was produced by the authentication generator. The existing user model defines the user's email address and password; we just need to add the user's name.

```
depot> bin/rails generate scaffold User \
  name:string email_address:string password:digest \
  --skip-collision-check --skip
```

We declare the password as a `digest` type, which will automatically handle HTTP Digest authentication[79] for us—another one of the nice extra touches that Rails provides.

Because we skipped the collision check, we need to manually update the migration:

rails80/depot_r/db/migrate/20250420000011_create_users.rb

```
class CreateUsers < ActiveRecord::Migration[8.0]
  def change
```